

# Calendar

## Combinatorics

### MATH 31003-01 - Fall 2026

I will put all deadlines on the Blackboard Calendar. Please check it regularly.

## 0.1 Key university dates

For official University dates, see the Fall 2026 academic calendar and the Registrar's final-exam schedule.

| Date                                     | Event                                                    |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Monday, August 17                        | Classes begin                                            |
| Monday, September 7                      | Labor Day holiday                                        |
| Tuesday, November 24–Friday, November 27 | Thanksgiving holiday                                     |
| Wednesday, December 9                    | Final exam: 8:00-10:00 a.m., Wednesday, December 9, 2026 |

## 0.2 Exams

| Date                                         | Assessment                      |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Friday, September 18 <b>TENTATIVE</b>        | Midterm 1                       |
| Friday, October 16 <b>TENTATIVE</b>          | Midterm 2                       |
| Friday, November 13 <b>TENTATIVE</b>         | Midterm 3                       |
| 8:00-10:00 a.m., Wednesday, December 9, 2026 | Exam 4 and mastery reassessment |

## 0.3 Daily lecture log

The public daily log below contains the lectures currently released. Later planning entries remain in the instructor's private lecture log and do not appear in this navigation.

| Wk                          | Lec                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | <b>L1: Set notation and basic counting</b>                                                  |
| 2026-08-17                  | Sets, cardinality, Cartesian products, and the sum rule.                                    |
|                             | <b>L2: Product rule and strings</b>                                                         |
| 2026-08-19                  | Product rule; strings with and without repetition.                                          |
|                             | <b>L3: More counting techniques</b>                                                         |
| 2026-08-21                  | Subtraction, division, permutations, combinations, and counting models.                     |
|                             | <b>L4: Applications of combinations and combinations with repetition</b>                    |
| 2026-08-22                  | Lattice paths. Repeated-letter anagrams and multinomial coefficients. Combinations with r   |
|                             | <b>L5: Review of choice models, increasing sequences, and basic binomial expansion</b>      |
| 2026-08-26                  | Choosing the correct model: does order matter and are repetitions allowed. A second biject  |
|                             | <b>L6: Polynomials, paths, Pascal recursion and restricted lattice paths, intro to in</b>   |
| 2026-08-28                  | Multinomial formula and polynomial expansions Coefficient extraction from powers of mult    |
|                             | <b>L7: Catalan paths and inclusion exclusion principle.</b>                                 |
| 2026-08-31                  | Reflection argument and Catalan numbers. Inclusion–exclusion for two, three, and finitely m |
|                             | <b>L8: Applications of inclusion–exclusion</b>                                              |
| 2026-09-02 <b>TENTATIVE</b> | Conclusion of proof of inclusion exclusion principle. Complement and violation-set formulat |
| <b>TENTATIVE</b>            | Lecture topics and assessment dates may change.                                             |

# 0.4 Week and unit overview

| Weeks |           | Unit                                     | Topic                                                   |
|-------|-----------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–4   | TENTATIVE | Unit I: Enumeration                      | Counting models, bijections, double counting, and incl  |
| 4–5   | TENTATIVE | Unit II: Generating-function foundations | Formal power series and ordinary generating-function    |
| 6–8   | TENTATIVE | Unit III: Recurrences                    | State models, linear recurrences, recursive evaluation, |
| 9–16  | TENTATIVE | Further topics                           | To be announced                                         |